

Service in a Snap: Food Pantry Organization & Maintenance

Estimated Time: 90 Minutes

Who: Troop / Patrol Quartermaster or Adult Leader

When: Monthly or as part of post-campout gear return

Impact: Ensures the Troop has safe, unexpired dry goods available for camping trips. This organization allows Grubmasters to quickly inventory "free" supplies, reducing Troop food costs and minimizing waste from expired or improperly stored items.

Requirements: Can be used toward service hours for Star/Life ranks or to fulfill leadership duties for the Quartermaster position. Relevant to Cooking Merit Badge requirements regarding food safety and storage.

Reference:

- Scout Handbook: Nutrition and Food Safety Section
- Cooking Merit Badge Pamphlet
- Service in a Snap (Troop Google Drive)

Your Mission

The objective is to clean, inspect, and organize the Troop's shared food pantry located in the gear closet. You must ensure all items are unexpired, containers are sealed to prevent pests/contamination, and supplies are labeled clearly for future Grubmaster use.

Preparation

1. **Pick up the Gear:** Coordinate with Troop Quartermaster to gain access to the Troop Gear Closet in the church.
2. **Gather Supplies:** Collect disinfectant wipes, trash bags, permanent markers, masking tape, and clear airtight storage bins.
3. **Set up Space:** Identify a clean, flat surface nearby (such as a folding table) to layout and inventory items.

Step-by-Step Instructions

- **Step 1: Clean Out** – Remove all dry goods and bins from the pantry shelves. Wipe down all shelving units and bin interiors with appropriate cleaning supplies.
- **Step 2: Labelling** – Check all bulk bins (e.g., "Spices," "Baking," "Paper Goods"). Re-label any containers where the ink has faded or the tape is peeling.
- **Step 3: Quality/Expiry Check** – Inspect every item for expiration dates. Discard any expired food or items in opened/compromised original packaging. Look for any signs of contamination or pest activity.
- **Step 4: Inventory** – Count the remaining safe items and record the quantities in the checklist below to identify what needs to be restocked.
- **Step 5: Restock** – Transfer any usable items from temporary "Consumable Stores" into the primary pantry bins.
- **Step 6: Organize** – Group like items together (e.g., all oils together, all seasonings together). Use the "First In, First Out" (FIFO) method by placing newer items at the back and older items at the front.
- **Step 7: Report** – Submit the finished inventory checklist and a report of any major missing supplies to  **Person** .

Mission Checklist & Inventory

Confirm the pantry contains the following standard dry goods and supplies.

Item Description	Required Qty	Actual Qty	Status / Notes
Salt & Pepper Sets	2		
Cooking Oil (Large)	2		
Assorted Spices (Bin)	1		
Cooking Spray	2		
Aluminum Foil (Rolls)	2		
Paper Towels (Rolls)	4		
Trash Bags (Box)	1 (Full)		
Dish Soap (Large)	1 (Full)		
Sanitizing Tablets	1 Bottle		
Matches (Waterproof Box)	2		

Notes:

Parent/Scout Name: _____ **Date:** _____

Troop Quartermaster: _____ **Date:** _____

Equipment Coordinator: _____ **Date:** _____